BARKFIELD ROAD

OPERATOR MANUAL

Barkfield Road Autoship Admin — what each page does, and how they work together.

VERSION 1 · OCTOBER 2026

This is a guide to the autoship admin: what each page is for, and how the pages fit together to get the right food to the right dog on the right day.

THE BIG PICTURE IN ONE MINUTE

It starts when a customer signs up for **auto-ship**:

1. **The customer signs up for auto-ship** — for example, "every 4 weeks, 2 bags of venison and a salmon oil."
2. **Staff create their customer profile** in the admin. It's linked to the customer's Square profile, which is where their card lives.
3. **Staff set up their subscription** — what they get and how often.
4. **From then on it repeats on its own schedule.** When a delivery is due, the admin turns the subscription into a **delivery** for that day, helps you **order and receive the stock**, **pack the box**, **charge the card** through Square, and **send the stop to Routific** so a driver gets a route.
5. **When the box is delivered**, the customer's next delivery date is set automatically, and the cycle starts again.

Two outside services do part of the work:

- **Square** holds the product prices and the customers' cards. Prices are changed in Square, never here. Cards are added or changed in Square, never here.
- **Routific** builds the driving routes. You send it the day's packed boxes; a dispatcher plans the route there; the finished route comes back here as a load list.

SETTING UP A NEW AUTO-SHIP CUSTOMER

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS	PAGE
1. Create the customer	Name, contact details, delivery address. The admin checks Square for an existing profile first and links to it, so there's never a duplicate	Customers → New customer
2. Add delivery details	Door notes (gate code, the dog), time at the door, preferred window — for the driver	The customer's page
3. Add their pets	Names, and any allergies	The customer's page → Pets
4. Make sure a card is on file	Cards are added in Square, on the customer's Square profile	Square
5. Create the subscription	What goes in each box and how often; then **Activate** it	Subscriptions → New subscription, or the customer's Subscriptions tab

Once the subscription is active, the customer comes up automatically on the day they're due.

THE DAY, IN ORDER

Most days follow the same path. Each step has its own page.

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS	PAGE
1. Make the day's deliveries	Every customer due that day gets a delivery with the right products in it	Deliveries → Generate
2. Order the stock	See how much of each product is needed, order it from suppliers	Procurement
3. Receive the stock	Tick off what arrived, decide what to do about anything that didn't	Procurement, or the delivery itself
4. Pack the boxes	Once everything for a box is sorted, mark it packed	Deliveries
5. Charge the cards	Charge the day through Square; follow up on any refused cards	Billing
6. Send for routing	Send the packed boxes to Routific	Dispatch
7. Load the van	Load from the load list, ticking each box in	Dispatch → Load list
8. Delivered	Routific reports each drop; the customer's next date is set	(automatic)

The **Dashboard** shows where today stands across all of these at a glance.

WHO CAN DO WHAT

What you see depends on your role. Buttons you can't use are simply hidden.

- **Administrator** — everything, including managing staff accounts.
- **Manager** — runs the whole operation day to day, including the automatic emails, but doesn't manage staff accounts.
- **Staff** — customers, subscriptions, packing, and charging the day's cards. Can see dispatch but not send to Routific. Can see the automatic emails and what was sent, but not change them.
- **Driver** — can see deliveries, the dispatch board and the load list. Can't change anything.

If you need something you can't see, ask an administrator to change your role.

THE PAGES

Dashboard

Your morning view. It shows:

- **A red alert at the top** if any cards were refused or any customer is owed a refund, with a button to go straight to Billing.
- **Four tiles:** today's deliveries (and how many are ready to pack), anything still to generate for today, how many units still need ordering this week, and how many deliveries are stuck waiting on out-of-stock items. Click a tile to open the page behind it.
- **Today's deliveries** with where each box is and whether it's paid.
- **Today's dispatch** — one line saying where the day is with Routific.
- **To order this week** — the products you most need to order.

Customers

Everyone on the autoship program.

The list — search by name, email or phone. Filters show customers not linked to Square, or include archived customers.

A customer's page shows:

- **Contact details and address.** Deliveries go to this address. A customer with no address can still have pickup or shipped orders, but not local delivery.
- **Delivery details, for the driver** — door notes (gate codes, the dog, where to leave the box), how long the driver usually spends at the door, and a preferred delivery window. These are read fresh every night, so a gate code changed this morning reaches tonight's driver.
- **Card on file** — kept in Square. To add or change a card, open the customer in Square.
- **Square link** — every customer should be linked to their Square profile, or their card can't be charged. If the link is missing, the page says so and offers to try again.
- **Email preferences** — whether they've agreed to marketing emails (and when that was recorded), and whether they want emails about their orders. Record it here when a customer tells you at the counter.
- **Tabs** for their pets, subscriptions and past deliveries.

Adding a customer — the page first checks Square for someone with the same email or phone, so you link to the existing Square profile instead of making a duplicate.

Archiving hides a customer from lists without deleting anything. It does **not** stop their subscriptions — pause or cancel those first if deliveries should stop. Archived customers can be restored.

Pets (on the customer's page)

Each pet has a name, type, breed, birthday, notes and **allergies**. Allergies are shown in red on each pet — they're what you check before a protein goes in a box.

- Pick allergies from the shared list. If one is missing, type it and add it to the list — it's then available for every pet.
- A pet that has passed away or been rehomed can be **taken off the list**. The record is kept, and you can find it again under "Show past pets."

Subscriptions

Each customer's auto-ship: what they get, and how often.

Each subscription has:

- **How often** — every so many days, weeks or months.
- **Standing items** — what goes in every box.
- **Rotations** — products the customer takes turns through, one per delivery (say, venison, then beef, then lamb). You can reorder a rotation, pause it, or send a particular one next "out of turn."
- **Add-ons** — one-time extras for the **next box only** (a birthday cake, a treat). They're used up once that box is delivered.
- **The next delivery date**, and a preview of the next few boxes.

Statuses:

- **New sign-up** — set up but not delivering yet. **Activate** it once it has something in it.
- **Active** — delivering on schedule.
- **Paused** — no deliveries. Pause with a date to resume automatically, or without one to resume by hand.
- **Canceled** — permanent. A customer who comes back gets a new subscription.

You can also **skip** the next delivery or **move** it to a different date.

Discontinued products on a subscription are flagged, because they'll still go in the box until someone swaps them out.

Deliveries

One delivery is one box for one customer on one day. This is where packing happens.

The list opens on the coming week. Each row shows how much is left to sort out on the box. Filter to **Blocked** (waiting on an out-of-stock decision) or **Ready to pack**.

A delivery's page shows every product in the box and where each one stands:

- **Pending** — not ordered yet.
- **Ordered** — on its way from the supplier.
- **Arrived** — all of it, or **part** of it (part stays on the to-do list).
- **Out of stock** — needs a decision: **send something else instead**, **send without it**, or wait.

When every product is sorted, **Mark packed** becomes available.

Once a box has been charged, its contents are fixed. You can't add products or change quantities. You can still mark something as not going — the page then flags that the customer is owed a refund, which you make in Square.

Managers can also:

- Edit the delivery's notes, its delivery window, and the time at the door — for this delivery only.
- **Mark delivered by hand** — only for pickups, shipped orders, or if Routific never confirmed. Normally Routific confirms each drop.
- **Mark failed**, with a reason.
- **Cancel** a delivery.

Generate deliveries

Turns the subscriptions due on a day into deliveries.

- Shows a **preview first**: who will get a delivery, and anyone being passed over and why (paused, no address, nothing in their subscription, and so on).
- **Warning — second boxes.** A customer stays "due" until their current box is actually delivered. So if you generate tomorrow before today's boxes have gone out, today's customers would get a **second box**. The page warns you in red and asks before doing it.

One-off delivery

A delivery that isn't part of any subscription — a one-time order. Pick the customer and the products.

Prep sheet

A printable pick list for a range of days, one entry per box. Products that aren't going are shown crossed out.

Procurement

Ordering and receiving stock, for a range of days.

By product — one row per product: how many to order, how many are on order, how many are in hand. From a product's menu:

- **Mark ordered** — when you've placed the supplier order.
- **Receive all** — when that product's delivery has arrived and you have it all in hand.
- **Out of stock** — the supplier can't supply. Each affected box is then blocked until someone decides what to send instead.

By line — one row per product per box, for the details. Tick several and update them together — for example, mark a batch as ordered.

Receiving is never done for a mixed selection — only per product ("I'm standing at the pallet") or one box at a time. Marking something as arrived when it hasn't means a customer misses out.

Billing

Charging the cards, through Square.

- **Charge the day** — charges every delivery that's ready and unpaid. You see a confirmation first, then one result list: paid, refused, couldn't be charged, and skipped, each with the customer's name.
- **Discounts** — pick from Square's discount list for a delivery before it's charged. Square works out the amount.
- **Needs attention:**
  - **Card refused** — ring the customer to fix their card in Square, then charge again.
  - **Not linked to Square** — link the customer first (on their customer page).
  - **Refund owed** — a paid box went out short. Make the refund in Square.

Charging can take a little while for a full day. Let it finish — closing the page won't stop a charge that's already under way.

Dispatch

Getting the day's boxes onto a route. Pick the day at the top (it opens on today).

The banner at the top tells you where the day is:

- **Waiting for boxes to be packed** — nothing is ready to send yet.
- **Ready to send** — packed boxes are ready. Press **Send for routing**. You'll see what's going and what isn't first. Unpaid boxes still go (cards often get fixed before the van leaves); unpacked ones don't.
- **Some deliveries haven't gone yet** — part of the day was sent. Send the rest once they're packed. Anything already sent is never sent twice.

- **Sent — waiting for a route** — everything has gone to Routific and a dispatcher is planning the route there. **Don't send the day again.** The route appears here by itself.
- **Route published** — the route is back. Open the load list.
- **Stop loading — a route was pulled back** (red). A dispatcher is re-planning. The plan on screen is out of date; wait for the new one before loading more.

Each row shows the box, whether it's paid, and whether it's gone to Routific.

- **Withdraw** takes a delivery back out of Routific — for a card that couldn't be fixed, or a cancellation. It can be sent again later. If it was already on a published route, take the box off the van.

If Routific refuses our login a red notice appears and stays. Trying again won't help — an administrator has to renew the Routific connection.

Load list

The sheet you load the van from. It's printable.

- **In loading order.** Number 1 goes in first, at the back. The last one is nearest the doors — it's the first drop. Load in the order shown.
- **One card per door.** Two boxes for the same address are one stop with two boxes. Tick **each box** into the van; the door only counts as loaded when every box is in.
- **What's actually going.** Quantities are what's really in the box. Anything not going is crossed out; a substitute is named by what's in the box.
- **Door notes and phone numbers** for everyone at that address.
- **Stops added in Routific** — the dispatcher sometimes adds a stop of their own (collect returns, for example). Nothing to load, but the driver still goes; tick it as "Ready to go."
- **Unpaid stops** are listed at the top — fix the card before the van leaves, or withdraw the box.

Products

The products available for subscriptions. **Square is in charge of names and prices** — this page mirrors it.

- **Add from Square** — search Square's catalog (it matches the start of words: "salm" finds salmon) and add the size or flavour you want. Products priced at the counter can't be added — give them a fixed price in Square first.
- **Sync with Square** — updates every product's name and price from Square. **Run it before a charging day** so customers pay today's prices. Anything Square no longer has is listed, not removed.
- **Discontinue** — stops a product appearing when building subscriptions and deliveries. Subscriptions that already have it keep sending it until someone swaps it out. You can restore it.

Users

Staff accounts (administrators only, for changes).

- **Add a user** — name, email, a starting password (or press "Suggest one"), and their roles. **No email is sent** — give them the password yourself; they can change it under My account.
- **Roles** are a fixed set: Administrator, Manager, Staff, Driver. A user needs at least one.
- **Administrator switch** — full access to everything, whatever their roles. Give it sparingly.
- **Deactivate** — locks someone out straight away. Nothing is deleted, and you can restore them. You can't deactivate your own account.
- Each user's page shows exactly what they're allowed to do.

My account

Your own details, and where you change your password.

Notifications

Emails the shop sends automatically. A **rule** says *"when this happens, send that email"* — for example, *"when a delivery becomes delivered, send 'Delivery confirmation'."* Every email a rule writes lands in the **outbox**, which is also the permanent record of what was sent.

> **Right now, no email service is connected.** Nothing actually reaches anyone's inbox yet. A yellow banner at the top of every Notifications tab says so, and in the outbox **"Sent" means "would have been sent."** This changes once an email provider is set up.

The section has four tabs.

Rules

Each rule reads as a sentence, with one of three states:

- **Off** — it does nothing.
- **Dry run** — it writes the emails it *would* send, but sends none. They appear in the outbox as "Not sent (dry run)."
- **Live** — it sends.

A new rule always starts off and in dry run. That's deliberate — an email can't be unsent. Take a new rule live in three steps:

1. **Turn it on.** It's now in dry run.
2. **Read what it would have sent** — the link on the rule takes you to those emails in the outbox.

3. **Go live** when you're happy with them. The page asks you to confirm.

A live rule can go **back to dry run** at any time.

Making a rule — choose what it reacts to (a delivery's status, a product on a delivery, a payment, or a number of days before the next delivery), then the email it sends and who it goes to: the customer, or the shop. *"Days before the next delivery"* rules are reminders, checked once a day; each customer gets one reminder per delivery.

A rule's page lets you rename it, change its email, and **preview** it for a real delivery — exactly what that customer would receive. If any detail in the email couldn't be filled in (shown like `{{ProductName}}`), it's flagged in red: the customer would see it like that. You can also **send a test** to yourself.

Outbox

Every email, newest first. Filter by status, rule or date. Click one to read exactly what it said.

STATUS	MEANS	WHAT TO DO
Waiting / Scheduled	Queued; scheduled ones wait for quiet hours to end	Nothing
Sent	Sent (or, for now, would have been)	Nothing
Not sent (dry run)	Its rule was in dry run, or sending was switched off	Nothing — not an error
Address blocked	The address is on the blocked list	Nothing
Failed	Couldn't be sent	**Retry**
Held for review	Deliberately not sent — see below	Read it; **send it** if it's safe

Held for review. If a customer's pet has any recorded allergy, an email saying *"we've sent something else instead"* is **never sent automatically**. The system can't tell whether the substitute contains something the pet is allergic to. So it waits: read it, check the substitute against the pet's allergies on the customer's page, and press **"It's safe — send it"** only if it is.

Send waiting emails now sends anything due straight away, rather than waiting for the next automatic pass.

Templates

What each email says. Plain text — the subject and the message. Details like the customer's name or the delivery date are added with the **Insert details** buttons, which offer only what's available for the rule's trigger. Built-in templates can be reworded but not deleted, and a template a rule uses can't be deleted either.

Marketing templates only ever go to customers who've agreed to marketing emails, and always carry an unsubscribe link.

Settings

- **Send emails** — the master switch. Turn it off to stop all sending at once; rules still write their emails, marked as not sent.
- **Quiet hours** — emails written during these hours wait until they end.
- **Most emails one customer gets in a day** — a safety cap. 0 means no limit.
- **The shop's address** — where rules addressed to the shop write (a refused card, stock blocking a delivery). Without one, those rules write nothing.
- **Reminders** — when the daily check last ran, and a button to run it now. Running it twice in a day is safe.
- **Blocked addresses** — nothing is ever sent to these. Unsubscribes and bounced addresses land here automatically; you can add one by hand.

MESSAGES YOU MIGHT SEE

- **"This delivery just changed" / "This customer changed while you were editing."** Someone else saved a change while you had the page open. Their change is shown — check it, then make yours again. Nothing of theirs was overwritten.
- **"Couldn't load..." with a Try again button.** The connection dropped or a service was busy. Try again in a moment.
- **"Square is unavailable" / "Routific is unavailable."** That service is down for now. Try again shortly.
- **"...rejected our credentials..."** The connection to Square or Routific needs renewing by an administrator. Trying again won't help.
- **Signed out unexpectedly.** Your session ended. Sign in again and you'll be taken back to where you were.

GOLDEN RULES

1. **Change prices and cards in Square**, not here.
2. **Don't generate tomorrow before today's boxes have gone out** — unless you mean to send second boxes.
3. **Only mark stock as arrived when it's in your hands.**
4. **Sync products with Square before a charging day.**
5. **Send the day to Routific once.** If the banner says "waiting for a route," it's already gone.
6. **If a route is pulled back, stop loading** until the new plan arrives.
7. **Load in the order on the load list.**
8. **Read a rule's dry run before taking it live.** An email can't be unsent.
9. **Check every "held for review" email against the pet's allergies** before sending it.

WORDS USED IN THE ADMIN

- **Auto-ship / Subscription** — the same thing: a customer's repeating order, with what goes in each box and how often.
- **Delivery** — one box for one customer on one day.
- **Line** — one product in a box.
- **Rotation** — products a customer takes turns through, one per delivery.
- **Add-on** — a one-time extra for the next box only.
- **Route** — the driver's plan for the day, built in Routific.
- **Stop** — one doorstep on a route; it can have more than one box.
- **Blocked** — a box waiting on a decision about an out-of-stock product.
- **Archived / Deactivated / Discontinued** — hidden and set aside, but kept and restorable.
- **Rule** — "when this happens, send that email."
- **Dry run** — a rule writing the emails it would send, without sending them.
- **Outbox** — every email the shop has written, sent or not.